ancient wood, whose edges were so perfect that the very lines of jointure were indistinguishable, evoked admiration of all who witnessed the experiment. The whole was built with a precision and reasoned care that could not possibly be excelled t o - d a y . . . . In short, the construction was absolute perfection of such work.

In other excavated buildings also in different parts of the country wooden logs and rafters have been found in an excellent state of preservation. This would be surprising anywhere, but in India it is more so, for the climate wears them away and all manner of insects eat them up. There must have been some special treatment of the wood; what this was is still, I believe, a mystery.

Between Pataliputra (Patna) and Gaya lie the impressive re-

mains of **Nalanda** university, which **was** to become famous in later days. It is not clear when this began functioning and there are no records of it in Ashoka's time.

Ashoka died in 232 **B.C.,** after ruling strenuously for forty-one years. Of him H. G. Wells says in his 'Outline of History':

'Amidst the tens of thousands of names of monarchs that crowd the columns of history, their majesties and graciousnesses and